



April 13, 2026

Texas Workforce Commission Attn: Cassandra Johnson RFA 32026-00162 — Workforce Readiness Training for CTE Students II

Dear TWC Grant Review Committee,

I am writing in support of The Collaborative Advocate's application for the Workforce Readiness Training for CTE Students II grant (RFA 32026-00162). Pflugerville Independent School District enthusiastically supports this proposed program and the partnership it represents.

The Collaborative Advocate's founder, Dr. Terry Flood, currently serves on the Pflugerville ISD School Health Advisory Council (SHAC), and we have an established working relationship with his organization. Dr. Flood has demonstrated a genuine commitment to the success and well-being of our students, particularly those in Career and Technical Education pathways.

The proposed ThriveUp Workforce Readiness Academy is a 15-week employability skills training program fully aligned to TEKS §127.15 (Career and Technical Education Employability Skills). The program covers all required standards across professional conduct, workplace rights, workplace safety, time management, and work ethic through 5 modules, 20 interactive lessons, and 50 scenario-based assessments. What distinguishes this program is its culturally responsive design — the curriculum was developed specifically for the population we serve, featuring relatable student characters, real-world workplace scenarios in industries where our students actually work, and practical guidance addressing barriers our students face such as transportation, access to professional clothing, and family responsibilities.

Key program features include:

- AI-powered mock interview practice and professional communication coaching available 24/7 via mobile app
- A progressive resume builder that threads across all 5 modules, so every student graduates with a complete, professional resume built from their real experiences
- Weekly live virtual check-ins connecting students with neighborhood champions — local professionals and mentors from their own communities
- Motivational video content from professionals who reflect the backgrounds and experiences of our students
- Integration with a broader ecosystem of career, financial literacy, and community resource tools
- A verifiable, LinkedIn-shareable Workforce Readiness Certificate for program completers

The curriculum is live and interactive on the ThriveUp platform, accessible from any device, and designed for phone-first delivery — recognizing that many of our students access the internet primarily through mobile devices.



Pflugerville ISD supports this partnership and is willing to:

- Coordinate with The Collaborative Advocate on access to CTE students in grades 9–12
- Work with our CTE department to integrate the program into existing career pathways
- Provide classroom or lab space for instructor-led sessions as available and appropriate
- Support student participation in weekly live virtual check-ins
- Share FERPA-compliant student outcome data for program evaluation purposes

We understand that this program is fully funded through the TWC grant and requires no financial commitment from the district. The Collaborative Advocate will provide all curriculum materials, trained facilitators, technology platform access, neighborhood champion coordination, and student credentialing at no cost to PflISD.

We believe this program will meaningfully strengthen our students' readiness for the workforce and complement our existing CTE offerings. The culturally responsive approach and community integration model align with our district's commitment to equity and student success. We look forward to collaborating with The Collaborative Advocate on this initiative.

Sincerely,

Traci Hendrix

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